

METHODOLOGY NOTE – Stakeholder Mapping

Version 3, revised 11 January 2026

PURPOSE

A repeatable method for mapping stakeholders on two axes – influence over the outcome, and alignment with the client's position – and for identifying the informal power that the organisation chart does not show.

METHOD

1. Long-list every named individual who can advance or block the outcome. Do not filter yet.
2. Score influence 1-5 from observed decision history, not from job title.
3. Score alignment minus-2 to plus-2 from their own words in interview, not from inference.
4. Plot. The dangerous quadrant is high influence, negative alignment, low visibility.
5. Interview at least two people about each high-influence individual. Self-report on alignment is unreliable; triangulation is the method.

FAILURE MODE

The most common error is scoring influence from the org chart. In the Aldgate Bank merger the three highest-influence individuals were all two levels below the named sponsor.

OUTPUT

A map, a named owner per high-influence stakeholder, and a specific message per quadrant.